

CART444-2026: RUBRIC BREAKDOWN

Rubric for Design System Evaluation

This rubric serves as a communication tool between us, articulating expectations and requirements of each project, and the evaluation criteria I will use in grading. I will grade each category of the rubric and provide feedback. If you have any questions, check in with me about your grades or other concerns during office hours or by making an appointment.

Key Evaluation Areas

- **Principles:** The identification and elucidation of Design System Principles & Philosophy, how do these principles guide and encapsulate the essence of your Design System.
- **Visual Design:** The **depth of study** and **consistency** with regards to grid, spacing, responsive design, aspect ratio, typography, layering, colour and components.
- **Component Library:** The depth of study and completeness of atoms, molecules, organisms and flexibility pertaining to the Design System.
- **Documentation:** Ensure clear usage guidelines and code snippets are available.
- **Systemisation:** The system scales well across different mediums.
- **Accessibility:** Ensure that standard accessibility guidelines are considered and adopted where applicable in the Design System (e.g., WCAG).

Grading Scale Definitions

- **A (Exemplary):** Functional, reliable, easy to use, and establishes unique and coherent design language (cohesion).
- **B (Proficient):** Generally functional and usable, but with minor gaps in foundation scaffold (cohesion) in documentation or consistency.
- **C (Developing):** Functional but requires significant cognitive load or effort to use due to inconsistency.
- **D/F (Inadequate):** Difficult to use, high rate of inconsistency, does not establish a coherent design language across different mediums.

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Design System Evaluation Rubric

Criteria	Proficient (3)	Developing (2)	Inadequate (1)
Foundation, Consistency & Cohesion	Visual Design (colour, typography, spacing etc.) is uniform across all components and platforms.	Generally consistent, but some components or layouts feel disjointed.	Lacks clear visual rules; high variation in style between elements.
Component Robustness	Components are atomic, reusable, and handle various states (hover, disabled, error).	Components are usable but lack states or are too specific, limiting reuse.	Components are not standardized or are hard to adapt.
Documentation & Guidance	Comprehensive documentation exists for usage, tokens, and code snippets.	Basic documentation is present but lacks context or examples.	Little to no documentation; "tribal knowledge" required to use.
Accessibility *	Approaches WCAG 2.1 AA standards; keyboard navigable, high contrast, ARIA labels implemented.	Partially compliant, but lacks accessibility checks on some components.	Accessibility not considered.
Design Systemization	Foundations (colour, spacing, typo etc.) are well defined, allowing easy updates.	Some tokens exist, but hardcoded values are still used frequently.	No tokens; manual styling required for every item.
Adoption & Usability	Designers and engineers use it frequently; speeds up workflow noticeably.	Adoption is mixed; some teams bypass the system.	The system is rarely used or actively ignored.

***NB – Accessibility:** Ensure that standard accessibility guidelines are considered and adopted wherever necessary in the Design System. Clearly note accessibility adaptations.